## OPER OFFENBACH

INTERVENTION / SKULPTUR / AKTION, OFFENBACH, 2018



*Oper Offenbach* (2018) Offenbach

Oper Offenbach took place as the final part of the collaborative project with Künstlerhaus Mousonturm on the tip of the harbour island in Offenbach, which is surrounded by inland waters on two sides. The unused terrain allowed the collective to think on a large scale and extend its sculptural practice into urban space. Oper Offenbach was created there in a public staging of its construction over several weeks, which visitors and passers-by could follow in a total of four building phases.

The first built intervention, Prospekte, consisted of four oversized billboards created in collaboration with the design collective Profi Aesthetics and the photographer Simon Keckeisen. The posted walls were placed on the harbour island and acted as stage set and advertising medium at once, drawing in even a distant audience on land through their exposed size.

In the next phase of construction, the sculpture Graben (Pit) was realised, a reinterpretation of an opera house's orchestra pit. The artists' spatial installation, for which they dug a 15-metre-long trench, reversed the original function of the pit — hiding the orchestra — and explicitly put the musicians on display. From an elevated viewpoint, visitors to Oper Offenbach could closely examine a chamber orchestra during a performance day.

In a further step, another traditional part of an opera house, the box, was placed at the scenic centre. YRD.Works recreated the private box, in which the desire for individual exclusivity is satisfied in a universal way, and it could be rented on three dates. The ten two-person boxes were played to at night by a harpist and allowed what is otherwise frowned upon at the opera: sleeping.

In the last part of the opera construction, the stage, YRD.Works once again deconstructed an architectural element typical of opera, the revolving stage. In conventional use, it allows quick scene changes and effective staging. The sculptural interpretation of the revolving stage in Oper Offenbach, however, shed its technical core and made room for the audience, who were invited to conquer the inside of the round sculpture. The Offenbach performance collective Baby of Control staged the stage, which was now outside the turntable.

In the process of each individual building phase, YRD.Works reflects on theatre and its staging in an unusual way and, through its interpretations, attempts a reassessment of the traditional reception of art.

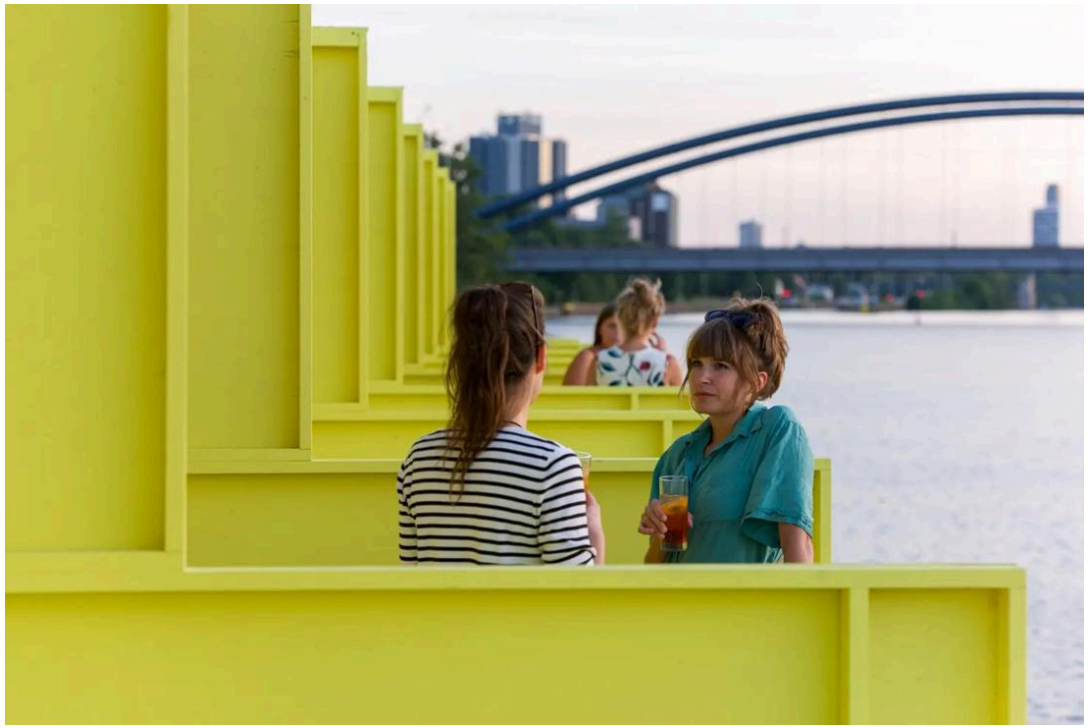


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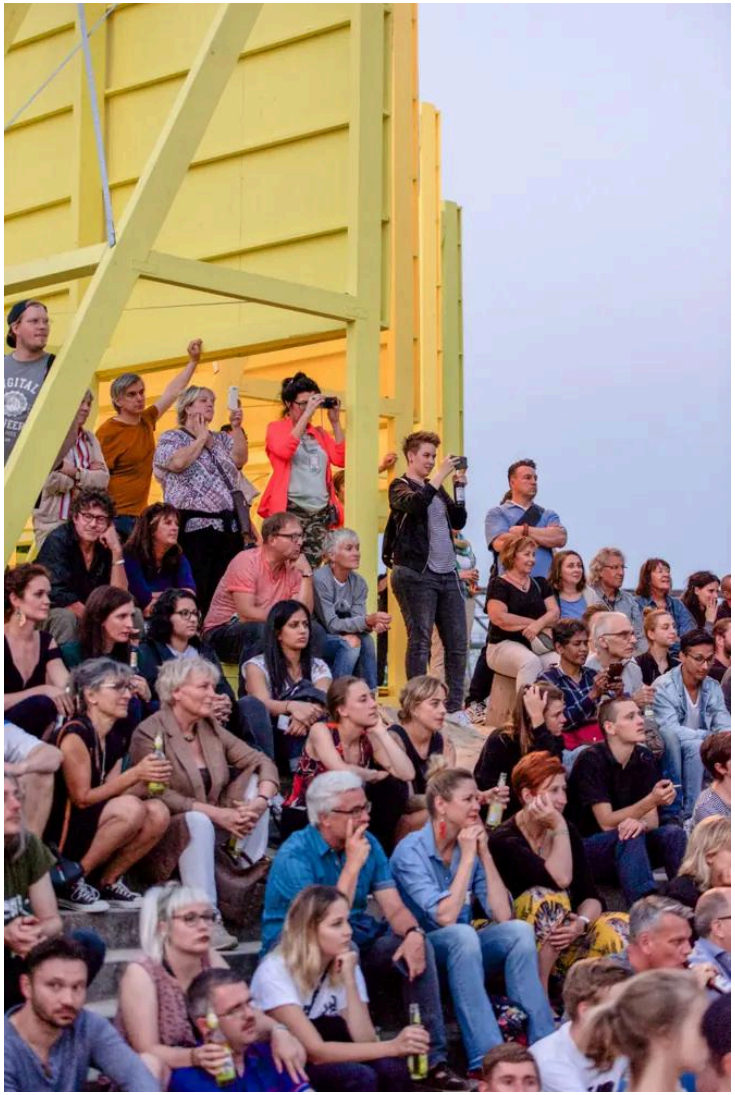
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